

- Title: **Gefräßige Schlange** (Essen Schlange Spiel)
- Short description of the game concept:

In this game, you will play the role of a greedy snake, which earn a living by “eating” the German letters or words. The longer your snake gets, the higher scores you get!

- Idea? A copy and variation of the traditional *Snake* game
- Theme? That’s a single-player digital game, aiming to help enhance players’ German language sensitivity and sense. Guiding language learners to experience inner logic and beauty of word choice and sentence construction.
- How to play?

Spielregeln: Du steuerst eine Schlange. Sie frisst Buchstaben oder Wörter.

1. einfach mode

Beispiel:

Wörter: lese, ich, ein, Buc

Richtig: Ich - lese - ein - Buch

2. mittel mode

Beispiel:

Die Schlange frisst: A E I N B U C H B

Darin ist das Wort EIN → +1 Punkt

Darin ist auch das Wort BUCH → noch +1 Punkt

3. schwer mode

Regel:

Gleich wie bei mittel

Aber: Die Schlange darf nicht durch sich selbst gehen und die Wand gehen

Dann ist das Spiel sofort zu Ende.

- Game Mechanismen: Das ist ein RPG-Spiel.

- How do players interact? We have set up a scoreboard on the end page, check your score after each round, compare it with others, and see who is the best player that grows the snake to the longest one!
- Target audience? German Beginners. People who would like to improve German words or sentence making without pressure and boring practice.
- Learning Goal(s):

What should be learned? Constructing basic German sentence and consolidating basic German vocabulary.

What should be reflected on? If the player can build correct German sentences and is familiar with the using of sentence compositions. The player can recognize and build more complete and correct German words. And words and sentences can be built fast and automatically.

- How is the topic being made accessible?

We chose the national-level snake game, which is easy for players to get started. We use this casual way of controlling the snake to make learning more accessible.

We set three difficulty levels, from easy sentences to hard word search. There are no time limit and punishment for wrong answers gives players no stress. Players can receive visible feedback with the snake growing and higher scores. To get more points, players will try to find more words or sentences to make the snake longer, which can stimulate players' motivation and interest to actively learn German. Learning can happen while playing.

- Narrative: Are there a story or scenarios? Yes! Hungry snakes need letters and words pieces collection. Which roles/perspectives are depicted? You are the hungry snake in this game.
- Aesthetics (not necessary in this phase of the project, but it is something worth thinking about for the refinement in the end-phase): Retro Pixel Art
- How should it be visualized?

The original concept was a smooth 2D flat game, with a flat graphic animation style. Because of time limitations, we finally simplified it to an old-fashioned basic pixel style in terms of visuals. While paying tribute, we believe that less is more. Minimalism lets you focus on words or sentence spelling and construction.

- What inspired your game?

Our inspiration comes from the typical and "historical" simple game Snake, which had a very simple logic at its core: eating equals scoring. Easy to play, yet attractive enough. Then we thought: why not change the collectible items to German letters or any possible word combinations? Why not reinforce players (especially German learners') thoughts or impressions, thus letting them really recognize and understand how words, or even whole sentences, can be created? Randomness maximizes their creativity and helps them jump out of their comfort zone actively. Most importantly, it's friendly for both introverts and extroverts, by being a self-inspiring and social currency at the same time (with the competitiveness enabled by the final scoreboard). And that's the charming point: Snake just follows humans' instincts to push you to continue.

- Materials/Format:

PC or laptop, and a sort of coding. Of course, it couldn't lack your brilliant minds to participate in our game.

- Challenges?

For game design, tiny value changes and variations among different levels are agonizing to set and calculate accurately. Specifically, the necessity of creating a gap between easy mode and medium mode is quite challenging. However, we finally designed a system using "words-to-sentence" and "letters-to-words" to create the gap between easy and medium modes, instead of just separating them by adding word types.

Because somehow, I think for u guys is not so fitful to just practice the different time tense or training to use the connector words in different level, I just totally believe your sentence making ability is good enough, and the letters-to-words is more challenging and highly playable. (Especially to help u recognize some specific or fixed prefixes and suffixes such as 'auf', 'mit', 'ge', 'ver' etc.) But if u think you still want some transitions from sentence creating to words making, please give us some advice, dank sehr!

Technically, the biggest challenge for our group work is to build the checking mechanism to determine whether points are scored or not. Especially when you put all the letters into one letter pool, you have to let the progress iterate on each new collection.